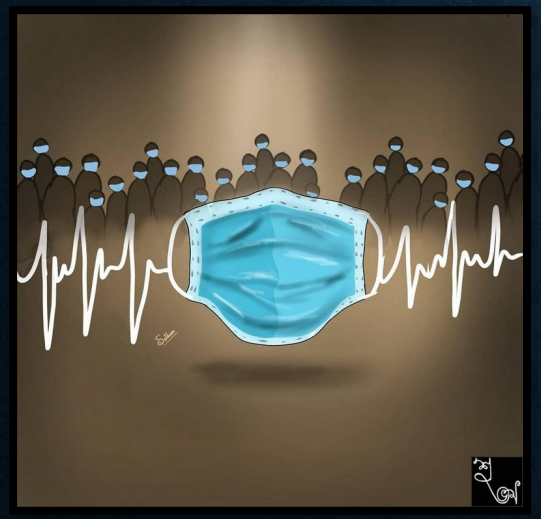




COVID-19

A SMALL OVERVIEW OF INDIA

Presented by – Avike Paul, Chirasree Mitra, Debangana Mandal, Debangana Usha Sinha, Dhriti Chattopadhyay, Ishita Datta

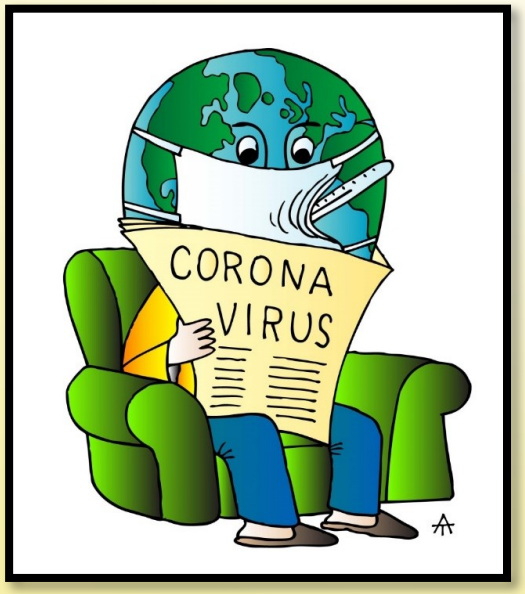
Batch Name – PRESIDENCY UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

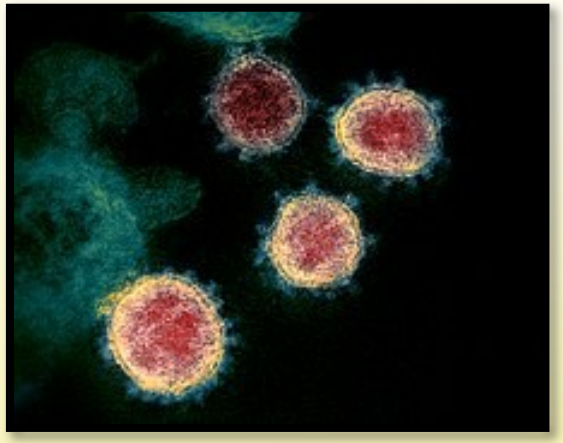
Trainer's Name – Gurmeet Ray



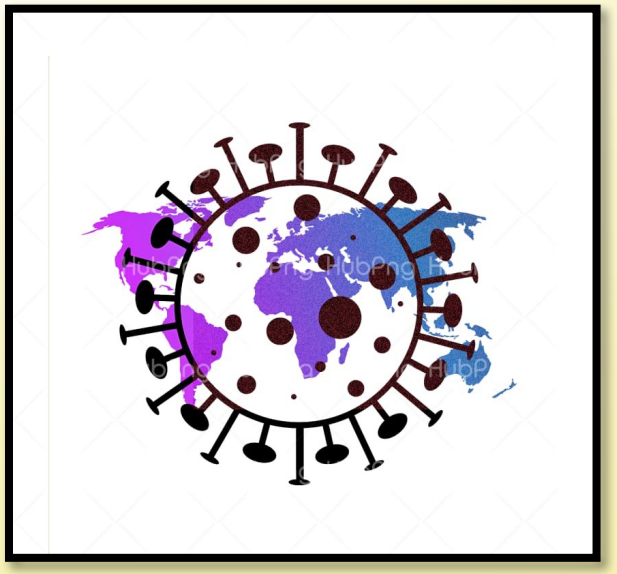
INTRODUCTION

COVID–19 or Coronavirus disease 2019 is an infectious disease caused by a newly discovered coronavirus named *severe acute respiratory syndrome coronavirus 2 (SARS–CoV–2)* that was first identified in Wuhan, China in 2019. In the name COVID–19, ‘CO’ stands for corona, ‘VI’ stands for virus, ‘D’ stands for disease and ‘19’ stands for the year 2019 as this virus was discovered in that year. Official name for the disease caused by the SARS C COVID–19 is declared as a pandemic by World Health Organization (WHO). Here the impact of COVID –19 & some policy recommendations in India and the preventive measures are discussed.





Transmission electron micrograph of SARS-CoV-2 virions with visible coronae



Impact of COVID-19 on Food and Agriculture in India

- The lockdown *disrupted food markets* which forced consumers to alter their consumption patterns.
- The *lockdown* coupled with sudden *negative income shock* posed serious concerns about food and nutrition security in India.
- Individuals have *lost their jobs* or their *income decreased* during lockdown.
- Restrictions on inter-state movements and absence of transportation disrupted the food supply chains and spiked food prices and affected farm operations.



Farmer crying as there is no harvesting

IMPACT of COVID-19 on FOOD and AGRICULTURAL SECTOR in INDIA

- Consumers changed their behavior patterns by reducing consumption of non-essentials, reduced market visits, stocking and consumption behavior changed equally across intensity of incidence viz., green, orange and red.
- Besides the pandemic, locust infestation from East Africa to India and natural calamities like cyclones and floods in eastern and western states caused devastation and had a catastrophic effect on agriculture.
- The need for adhering to the social distancing norms led the Government of India suspend the Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC) Act enabling many temporary local markets and procurement centers.



Supply trucks parked at their yard at Kolkata, amidst lockdown



Huge stocks of food grains in FCI warehouses

POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS for FOOD and AGRICULTURAL SECTOR



10-point Strategy to strengthen the Agricultural sector post COVID-19

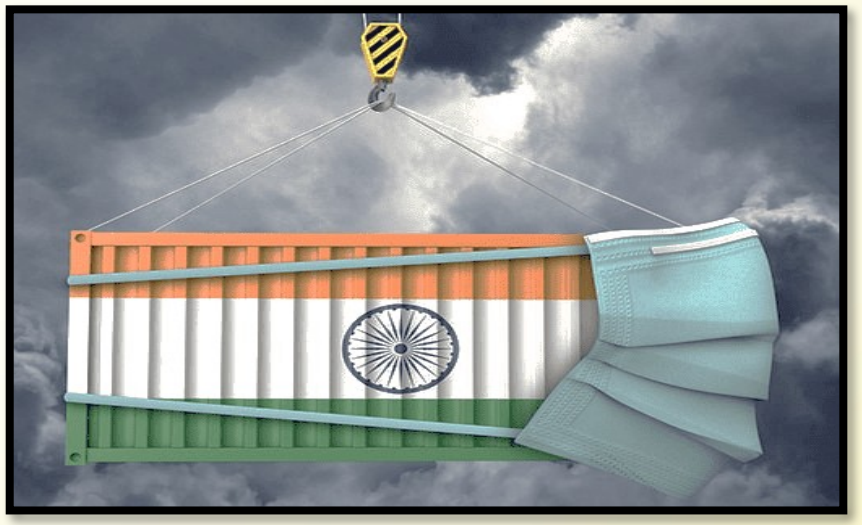
IMPACT of COVID-19 on MANUFACTURING SECTOR in INDIA

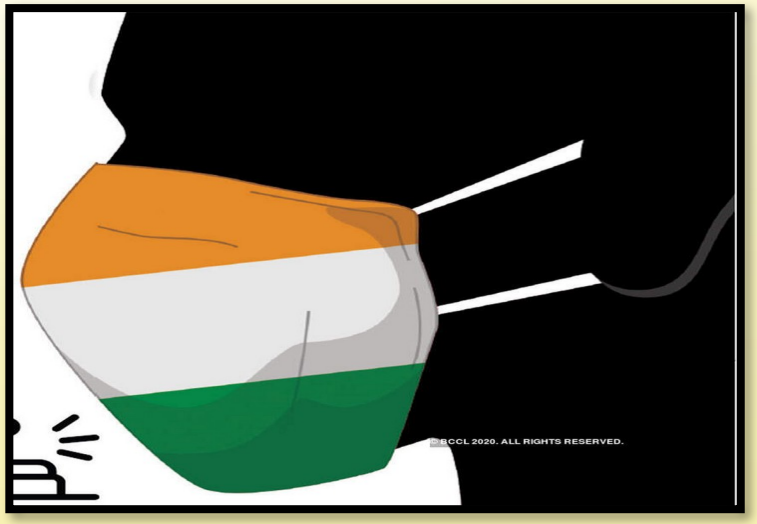
- **Supply side disruptions:**
  Due to lockdown and restriction on transportation (domestic and international), the supply chain got adversely affected.
- **Decreased demand:**
  As uncertainty about the future increased, the demand for goods and services decreased significantly.
- **Unemployment:**
  Lack of demand and disrupted supply led to decreased production of goods and services. This in turn led to staff reduction in many companies leaving a large number of people unemployed.
- **Labor shortage:**
  This is a labor-intensive sector. So, labor migration highly plagued the production.
- **Liquidity crunches:**
  The small businesses and retails were highly affected by the pandemic as they faced liquidity crunches and stretched working capital.



POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS for MANUFACTURING SECTOR

- Ensuring the health of staff and identifying vulnerabilities is very crucial at this point in time. The companies should deploy short term liquidity measures and secure funding and government aid.
- Focusing on electric cars manufacture can also help in reviving the sector.
- To ensure that the global supply chain is not disrupted, import, export and custom clearance activity should be declared and import tariffs on essential feed stock of chemical companies should be reviewed to facilitate sufficient competitive supply.
- There should not be any pay cuts in wages of workers or staff.
- With increasing awareness, enrolment of a greater number of students in schools and colleges, will provide higher demand in paper consumption in India.
- Home deliveries should increase. This will increase the demand for paper as well as provide employment to a greater number of people.



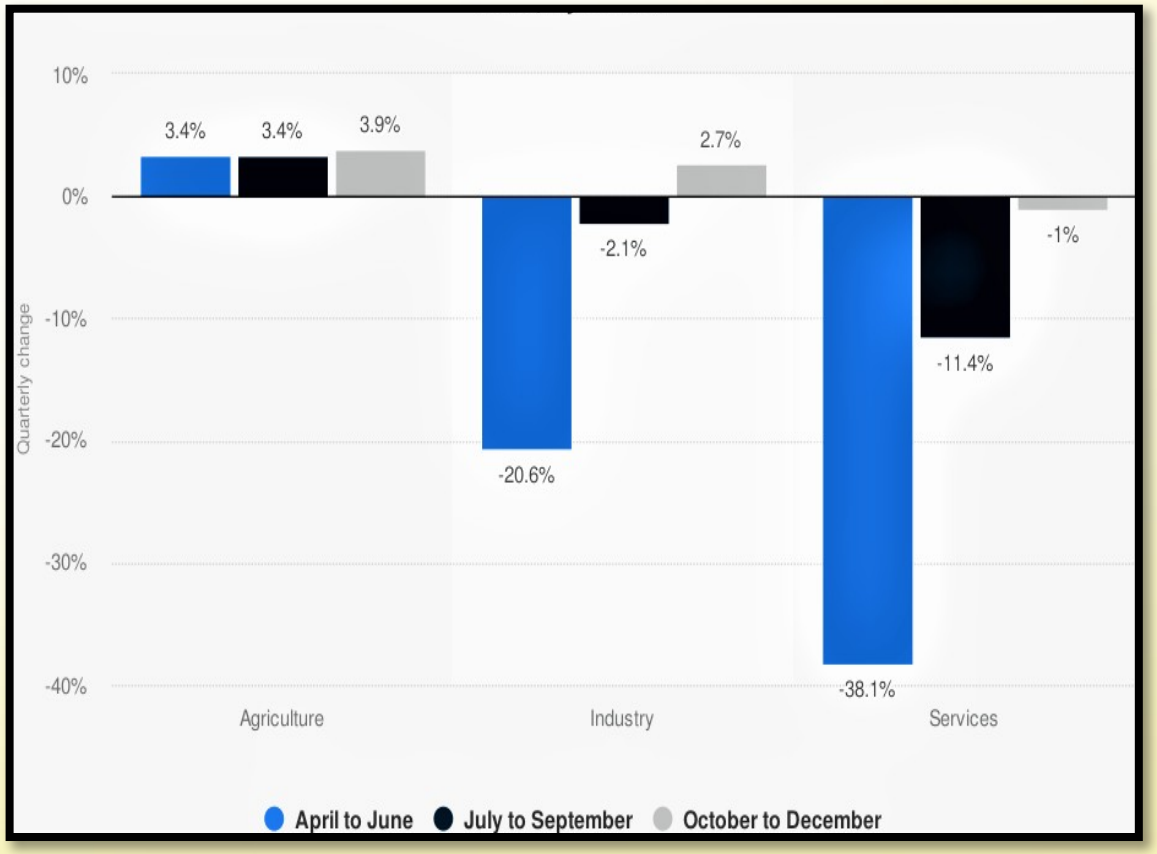


IMPACT of COVID-19 on SERVICE SECTOR in INDIA

From call centers to hotels to airlines, India's key services industries have come to a standstill during the coronavirus outbreak, dragging the economy into possibly its worst recession on record. Businesses providing services of everything from technology to travel and trade were the first to be hit when the government took unprecedented steps to lock down a nation of 1.3 billion people to stem the pandemic's spread.

The pandemic poses a challenge for companies such as Infosys Ltd. and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd., who are part of India's $181-billion IT services industry that builds software and provides services to some of the world's biggest banks and retailers. While Infosys and smaller rival Wipro Ltd. refrained from projecting full-year revenue, TCS reported a 1% slip in quarterly profit.

Services emerged as the key employment growth engine before the crisis hit, with the sector even outperforming agriculture and industrial expansion when the economy was slowing last year. The lockdown though has forced businesses offering services like ride-hailing, food delivery, hotel bookings and real estate to cut jobs in recent months. About 122 million people were out of jobs in April alone, according to estimates by the Center for Monitoring Indian Economy Pvt. India has allowed businesses to begin gradually reopening since April 20, but a shortage of workers has made it difficult to resume operations fully. The lockdown left millions of migrant workers stranded around the country without access to incomes, while millions more fled to their villages and are reluctant to return to the cities..



Estimated impact from the Covid19 on India from April to December 2020

POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS for SERVICE SECTOR

KEEPING THE PRIVATE SECTOR ALIVE DURING THE CORONAVIRUS (COVID-19)

4 lessons from past crises

1 INTERNATIONAL FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS MUST ACT FAST



Governments are often the fastest way to get support to the private sector. When the World Bank provides general budget financing, it can be channeled to banks and businesses to fund payrolls, provide guarantees, credit or loan forbearance.

World Bank Investment Lending can get to enterprises faster when adding finance to existing loans and when designing new simple or repeater loans. IFC's direct support to the private sector should focus on programs and instruments that already have a solid track record and have shown the capacity for rapid mobilization during a crisis.

2 MAKE SURE PROJECTS REACH THE BUSINESSES THAT NEED THE HELP



Rapid project preparation is critical during a crisis, but it is vital they are well designed with effective systems for targeting the hardest-hit businesses and monitoring to ensure the help has actually reached them. Financial intermediary loans have been widely used during crisis but subsequent evaluations found that few FILs were able to disburse rapidly, targeting was an ongoing problem for many of them, and results monitoring was weak

3 UNDERSTANDING THE BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT IS KEY



Drawing from an existing stock of knowledge or commissioning new analytic and advisory work can ensure that interventions are aimed at the most important problems faced by the private sector, and that resources are directed to their best uses. In countries where pre-crisis engagement was low, knowledge gaps left the Bank unprepared to help map out actionable, forward-looking programs and the quality of lending suffered.

4 WHEN THE CRISIS IS OVER, THE PRIVATE SECTOR STILL NEEDS SUPPORT



Even when responding to a crisis, there is a need for longer term planning, focused on an enduring restoration of growth and employment, and sustained responses. A roadmap for crisis engagement should be based on ongoing, systemic analysis of stress factors, a framework for coordination within the World Bank Group and with other international financial institutions, and a review of instruments for effective crisis support, meaningful growth and medium-term development.

IMPACT of COVID-19 on Women & Children in INDIA

- More women than men, work without *protection under labour protection laws*. So, lockdowns *disproportionately* threaten their livelihoods.
- Most children, as defined as an individual under 14 years of age, work as *daily wage labourers* without any job security or are *financially dependent on their guardians*. This puts them at an increased *risk of abuse, bad parenting* amidst this lockdown.

Deeper into the health aspect :

- Women and adolescent girls are less likely to receive adequate health care, medicines, vaccines or even insurance coverage for women hygiene, especially in rural or marginalised communities due to redirection of available resources in controlling the virus.
- Globally, women being the front-runners in the health workforce (nurses, midwives, community healthcare specialists, cleaners, launders, caterers) stand greater risks at getting exposed to the virus but have less access to personal protective or correctly sized equipment.
- Diversion of attention and critical resources away from sexual/reproductive and maternal health care facilities to corona infected patients may increase maternal mortality and morbidity rates, adolescent pregnancies, HIV and sexually transmitted diseases.



Preventive Measures



- Maintain a safe distance from others, even if they don't appear to be sick.
- Wear a mask in public, especially indoors or when physical distancing is not possible.
- Choose open, well-ventilated spaces over closed ones. Open a window if indoors.
- Clean your hands often. Use soap and water, or an alcohol-based hand rub.

- If you have a fever, cough and difficulty breathing, seek medical attention. Call in advance so your healthcare provider can direct you to the right health facility. This protects you, and prevents the spread of viruses and other infection
- Get vaccinated on your turn.



PICTURE GALLERY



STAY HOME



STAY SAFE

